Free-falling

A flying snake cannot actually fly, but it can glide long distances from tree to tree. It usually takes off from a higher branch, and steers by twisting its body and using its tail as a rudder.

Flying snakes can drop right out of the danger zone.

The snake pulls in its belly to trap a layer of air, which cushions its fall.

Ready for takeoff

This may sound like a fairy tale, but flying dragons leap from tree to tree in the rain forests of Southeast Asia. They have a fine pair of colorful "wings," which they lift up when ready to glide.

